

Copia Org Repo Cloner

User Guide

How to clone every repository in your Copia organization — using the app, the command line, or on a schedule.

Overview

The Copia Org Repo Cloner downloads (“clones”) every repository in a Copia organization to a folder on your computer. It is useful for making local backups, keeping an offline copy of all your projects, or preparing an archive.

You can use it three ways:

- **As a desktop app** with a simple window — fill in a few fields and click a button.
- **From the command line** for scripting or automation.
- **On a schedule** using Windows Task Scheduler, so backups run automatically.

Before You Begin

You will need

- A Windows PC.
- **Git for Windows installed.** The cloner uses Git behind the scenes. If it isn’t installed, downloads will fail. Get it from git-scm.com/download/win.
- **Your Copia sign-in details:** an access token, and the name of the organization you want to clone.

Getting your Copia access token

The token is like a password that lets the app sign in to Copia on your behalf. Create one in Copia under your account settings (Applications → Generate New Token). Copy it somewhere safe — you’ll paste it into the app once.

Keep your token private

Treat your token like a password. Anyone who has it can access your Copia repositories. This app never shows it on screen and only stores it in encrypted form (see “Keeping Your Token Secure”).

Using the App

Starting it

If you have the packaged program, double-click `CopiaRepoCloner.exe`.

The main window

Fill in the fields at the top, choose your options, then click Start Cloning. Here is what each field does:

Field	What it does
Origin URL	Your Copia address. Leave the default (https://app.copia.io) unless running a Copia self-hosted instance.
Auth token	Paste your Copia token here. Tick “Show” to check it, then untick to hide it again.
Organization	The organization to clone. Type its exact name — it’s required (the app clones one organization at a time).
Branch	Leave blank to get each repository’s default branch (recommended). Only fill this in if you specifically want one named branch from every repository.
Target directory	Where the repositories are saved. Click Browse... to choose a folder. Repos are placed under <target>\<organization>\<repo>.

Options

Option	What it does
Workers	How many repositories to download at the same time. 4 is a good default; raise it to go faster on a fast connection.
History	Shallow (recommended) grabs only the latest version of each repo — fast and small. Full downloads the entire history of every repo.
Stop after	Handy for a test run. Set it to a small number (e.g. 2) to clone just the first couple of repos, then set it back to 0 to clone everything.
Remember token (encrypted)	Saves your settings, including the token in encrypted form, so you don’t have to re-enter it next time. Your token is securely protected using Windows DPAPI encryption, ensuring it can only be accessed by your specific Windows user account.
Write log file	Also saves a timestamped record of the run as a text file next to the app.

Running a clone

1. Enter your Origin URL, token, and the organization name.
2. Click Browse... and choose where you want the repositories saved.
3. Leave History on Shallow for a fast backup, or choose Full for complete history.
4. Click Start Cloning.

As it runs, the **progress bar** fills up and the **log area** lists each repository with [ok] or [FAIL]. A small **spinner** with an elapsed timer (e.g. \ working 1:07) shows the app is still busy — useful during large repositories where the progress bar may pause for a moment.

When it finishes you’ll see a summary such as Complete: 24 cloned, 0 failed (of 24). If any repository failed, its name and the reason are listed so you can look into it.

Handy buttons

- **Cancel** — stops starting new downloads (any in progress finish).
- **Save Settings** — remembers your entries for next time.
- **Open Target** — opens the folder your repositories were saved to.
- **Open Log Folder** — opens the folder where the app and its log files live.

- **Make Scheduler Script** — creates files for automatic scheduled backups (see below).

Using the Command Line

Prefer typing commands, or want to run without the window? Add `--cli` and pass your settings as options.

```
python clone_org_repos.py --cli --org YourOrg --target C:\Backups --workers 6
```

Common options:

Option	Meaning
<code>--org NAME</code>	Organization to clone
<code>--target DIR</code>	Folder to save into
<code>--token TOKEN</code>	Your token (if omitted, you'll be asked for it privately)
<code>--history shallow full</code>	Latest version only, or full history
<code>--workers N</code>	How many to download at once
<code>--stop-after N</code>	Clone only the first N repositories (0 = all)
<code>--log-to-file</code>	Also write a timestamped log file of the run
<code>--save-config</code>	Save these settings for next time

For the complete list, run `python clone_org_repos.py --help`.

Scheduling Automatic Backups

You can have Windows run the cloner automatically — for example, every night — so you always have a fresh backup.

Step 1: Create the scheduler script

1. Open the app and fill in all your settings the way you want the automatic run to work (organization, target folder, history, etc.), including your token.
2. Click Make Scheduler Script.
3. The app saves your settings (with the token encrypted) and creates two files next to it: `run_clone.bat` and `run_clone.ps1`. You can use either one.

Step 2: Add it to Windows Task Scheduler

1. Open Task Scheduler (press Start, type “Task Scheduler”).
2. Click Create Basic Task, give it a name like “Copia Repo Backup”, and choose when it should run.
3. For the action, choose **Start a program**, and browse to the `run_clone.bat` file the app created.
4. Finish the wizard.

Important: run the task as your own Windows account

For security, your token is encrypted so that only **your Windows user account** can unlock it. When setting up the scheduled task, make sure it runs as you. “Run whether the user is logged on or not” is fine — it just has to be your account, on this PC.

Each scheduled run automatically writes a log file next to the app, so you can check that backups are working. Use the **Open Log Folder** button to find them.

Keeping Your Token Secure

- The app hides your token on screen and never displays it in logs or error messages.
- It only saves your token if you tick **Remember token** (or when you create a scheduler script). When saved, it is encrypted using Windows' built-in protection and tied to your Windows account — so the settings file is useless to anyone who copies it to another computer or user.
- If you ever move the app to another PC or user account, you'll simply be asked to enter your token again.

Troubleshooting

If you see...	What it means / what to do
Every repository fails immediately	Usually, the token or organization name is wrong. Double-check both — the organization name must match exactly.
"GitPython is not installed" or Git errors	Install Git for Windows (git-scm.com/download/win), then try again.
A few repositories fail with "not found" or "denied"	Your token may not have access to those specific repositories. The rest will still clone; failed ones are listed at the end.
It looks frozen on a big repository	It's almost certainly still working. Watch the spinner and timer next to the progress bar — if they're moving, just wait.
The scheduled task does nothing / asks for a token	Make sure the task runs as your own Windows account, and that you clicked "Make Scheduler Script" after entering your token.

Quick Reference

- **Fastest full backup:** token + organization + target folder, History = Shallow, Start Cloning.
- **Test first:** set Stop after = 2 to try a couple of repos before doing them all.
- **Automate it:** Make Scheduler Script, then point Windows Task Scheduler at run_clone.bat.